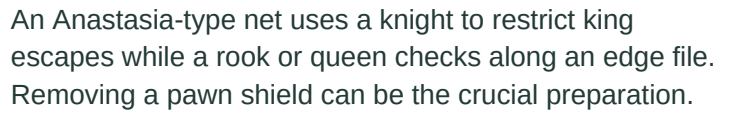


Anastasia mating nets

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Locate the knight's controlled flight squares and the heavy piece's checking line. Follow how the combination opens that line.

The defending king is on a6. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and bishop on e6. Check for tactical protection.

Previous move: 33...Kxa6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

34. Ra1+ Ba2 35. Rxa2+ Ra4 36. Rxa4#

34.Ra1+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **34...Ba2.**

35.Rxa2+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the bishop on a2. Recorded reply: **35...Ra4**.

36.Rxa4# Mate: rook on a4 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a6. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on a4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

The knight is often a supporting piece rather than the final checker. Do not overlook its quiet control of escape squares.